Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Capital Projects Group (GO & UP), GO Expansion - USRC
Metrolinx, 130 Adelaide Street West, Toronto, ON

Re: Project Manager, Union Station Rail Corridor, Temporary Assignment (Job ID 116577)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager, Union Station Rail Corridor position with the GO Expansion USRC project. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx in GO rail service design.

Much of the role is keeping a project moving: tracking day-to-day tasks, reporting to management, and working with municipalities, transit authorities, agencies and property owners to resolve issues. At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself and reporting progress to the people relying on it, and I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction construction on an operating railway imposes, would do to service. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations of Ontario Line construction staging.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not managed the planning, design, construction or commissioning of rail infrastructure, coordinated cost estimates, or supervised staff, and my knowledge of construction in an operating railway comes from assessing what slow orders do to service. I do not hold a PMP, P.Eng. or Class G licence, which the posting lists as assets.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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